

Birds of prey

Also known as “raptors”, birds of prey have exceptional vision, grasping talons, and a sharp, hooked beak. Found on every continent apart from Antarctica, these spectacular hunters are divided into day-flying raptors and night-flying raptors, or owls.

WHAT MAKES A BIRD A RAPTOR?

Day-flying raptors in particular have excellent eyesight that allows them to spot prey from a distance and to calculate exactly when to strike. Many owls rely more on their keen hearing. Strong feet and talons are a raptor's main tools of attack, while the hooked beak is used for tearing meat.



CURVED BEAK
Powerful beaks can pierce prey, rip off skin, and tear flesh into chunks.



KEEN EYESIGHT
Large, forward-facing eyes enable raptors to detect and capture their prey.

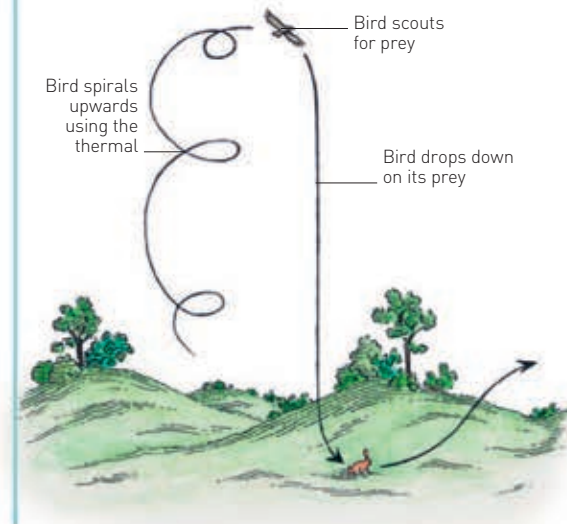


KILLING FEET
Long, curved talons are designed to grasp prey such as rabbits.

AN EAGLE'S VISION IS AT LEAST FOUR TIMES MORE POWERFUL THAN THAT OF A HUMAN

SOARING HIGH

The large wings of some hawks and eagles allow them to soar high in the sky by riding warm air currents called thermals. Using little energy, they can glide for long periods while searching for prey.



DAY-FLYING RAPTOR

As well as airborne hunters like hawks, eagles, and falcons, this group also includes the largely ground-dwelling secretary birds. Vultures, such as the Andean Condor, rarely kill prey and instead feed on dead animals.

